

13. QA Automation Program – Leadership Working Update (As of 01/21/2026)



Period Covered: Jan 8, 2026 Jan 21, 2026

Owner: QA Automation Program

Purpose: Detailed working update since last leadership share-out (Jan 8)

1. Executive Context (What Changed Since Jan 8)

Since the Jan 8 leadership update, the QA Automation team has shifted into a **high-support, high-velocity execution phase**, balancing:

- Stabilization and flakiness cleanup (Prime v2)
- Rapid enablement of **Prime v3 IDP smoke coverage** for emergency and dependency-driven releases
- Migration of **NYD IDP flows from v2 to v3**
- Ongoing support for **unplanned but business-critical initiatives** (SSS, dependency syncs, emergency releases)

Despite the increase in ad-hoc and urgent support demand, the team has continued to **expand automation coverage, stabilize pipelines, and absorb production-critical testing needs** without missing execution windows.

2. Prime Version 2 – Regression Stabilization & Cleanup

Progress Since Jan 8

- Team is actively **addressing and eliminating flaky test cases** across Prime v2
- Flakiness work is now the **primary remaining activity** for v2
- No new functional gaps identified during this period

Test Case Growth

- **Jan 8 baseline:** ~250 test cases
- **Current: 284 test cases**
- Growth reflects:
 - Stabilized scenarios
 - Refined validations
 - Removal of false positives and brittle assertions

Execution Model

- Offshore team continues full ownership of:
 - Nightly regression analysis
 - Failure classification
 - Early-morning execution readiness
- This model is now **fully operational and sustainable**

3. Prime Version 3 – IDP, Universal Enrollment & Emergency Coverage

IDP Smoke Coverage (New Since Jan 8)

- **IDP smoke tests added** specifically to:
 - Validate emergency releases
 - Support dependency sync changes
 - Cover urgent production-adjacent fixes
- These smokes are now actively used for **time-sensitive release validation**

Universal Enrollment (NY IDP Migration)

- All **NYD IDP flows migrated from v2 to v3**
- Universal Enrollment automation expanded to support:
 - IDP login
 - UE flows in Stage 1
- V3 now acts as the **primary automation surface for NY IDP**

Test Case Growth

- **Jan 8 baseline:** ~140 test cases
- **Current:** ~250 test cases
 - Includes NYD IDP login
 - NYD Universal Enrollment scenarios
 - Smoke + regression coverage to support emergency releases

4. Emergency & Unplanned Release Support (Key Focus Area)

Support Provided (Jan 8 Jan 21)

- Multiple **critical and emergency releases** supported by QA Automation
- Example:
 - **Emergency release on Jan 21** — automation support was instrumental in:
 - Early defect identification
 - Validation of redirect logic
 - Timing and performance behavior checks

Nature of Requests

- These efforts typically:
 - Enter without prior planning
 - Require immediate test execution
 - Pull team capacity from roadmap work

Team Response

- Offshore team played a **key role** in:
 - Rapid analysis
 - Overnight regression review
 - Early issue surfacing before business hours
- Onshore/offshore coordination enabled **same-day confidence for releases**

*Key takeaway: Automation is now a **dependency for emergency releases**, not just planned regression.*

5. Offshore Team Impact & Ownership

The offshore team has become a **critical execution pillar**, not just a support function.

Responsibilities Actively Owned

- Full nightly regression execution
- Failure triage and RCA preparation
- Early-morning validation before onshore hours
- Ad-hoc support during urgent release windows

Observed Impact

- Faster detection of release-blocking issues
- Reduced onshore context-switching
- Higher confidence in emergency and dependency-driven releases

Kudos

The offshore team's maturity is now enabling the program to **scale support without proportional headcount increases**.

6. API & Performance Testing – Current State

API Testing

- Baseline setups and documentation in place
- Coverage exists at framework and process level

- **Manual test cases are currently missing**
 - Identified gap
 - Logged in backlog
 - Not blocking current automation enablement

Performance Testing

- Ownership established for IDP login flows
- Team supporting new performance-related asks as they arise
- Manual coverage gaps acknowledged and tracked

*For both areas, the **current focus is pipeline readiness and aggregation**, with manual coverage planned post-baseline stabilization.*

7. Cross-Team & Platform Support

QA Automation is increasingly pulled into **platform-level efforts**, including:

- Scrum-of-Scrum dependency sync testing
- SSS-driven initiatives
- Apache 2.4.x upgrade validation
- Stage 5 CAT environment readiness
 - Access obtained
 - Smoke suite creation pending

These efforts are **high priority for the organization**, but often arrive **outside the planned intake model**.

8. Key Risk Emerging: Unplanned Support Load

What's Changing

- QA Automation is now treated as a **default validation layer** for:
 - Emergency releases
 - Platform upgrades
 - Cross-team dependencies
- These requests:
 - Are urgent
 - Are valid
 - But are **not consistently planned or capacity-aligned**

Risk

- Sustained unplanned support can:
 - Slow roadmap delivery
 - Delay flakiness cleanup and pipeline expansion
 - Reduce predictability

This Needs Leadership Alignment

Not a complaint — a **decision point**.

9. Leadership Discussion Points (To Align On)

These are the **explicit items to discuss** in the meeting:

1. **Support vs Roadmap Balance**
 - How much unplanned support should QA Automation absorb by default?
2. **Intake Expectations**
 - When does an emergency request require leadership visibility?
3. **Capacity Protection**
 - How do we protect roadmap work while still supporting critical releases?
4. **Environment Readiness**
 - Prioritization of Stage 5 CAT smoke enablement

5. API / Performance Manual Coverage

- Confirm timing expectations (post-pipeline vs parallel)

10. Summary

Between Jan 8 and now, the team has:

- Increased automation coverage across **v2 and v3**
- Enabled **IDP smoke testing** for emergency and dependency releases
- Successfully migrated **NY IDP flows to v3**
- Supported multiple **business-critical, unplanned releases**
- Demonstrated strong offshore ownership and maturity

The program is performing well — **but it is now operating at a level where leadership alignment on intake and support expectations is essential to sustain delivery quality.**